

Preston Carey Leslie

843-694-6959 | prestoncarey90@gmail.com | prestoncarey90.github.io/portfolio/ | linkedin.com/in/preston-leslie

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Crystal Marion & Selection Committee
Oregon Department of Human Services (ODHS)
500 Summer St NE
Salem, OR 97301

Re: Application for Data Operations Manager (Business Operations Manager 2) – REQ-203260

Dear Crystal Marion and Selection Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Data Operations Manager position with the Oregon Department of Human Services. While my current mailing address is in New York, I am actively planning a fully self-funded relocation to Oregon. I am deeply committed to building my long-term career and home in the Pacific Northwest, and the opportunity to lead data operations that directly serve more than one million Oregonians aligns perfectly with my professional goals and public service values.

My core operational strength lies in acting as a bridge between frontline operational realities and technical data architecture. Having spent over a decade optimizing workflows, leading unionized personnel, and navigating complex platform migrations in healthcare and hospitality, I understand how operational friction impacts service delivery. I paired this hands-on leadership background with a Master of Science in Quantitative Methods and Modeling from Baruch College, building a solid academic engine in SQL, Python data pipelines, and database governance. This enables me to speak fluent "tech" with IT engineers while remaining grounded in the practical, day-to-day needs of program staff and executive leadership.

I am eager to bring this unique hybrid background to the ODHS Data Office across several key areas:

- **Operational Leadership & Process Improvement:** Proven track record of evaluating frontline bottlenecks, designing tracking systems, and reducing latency (such as achieving a 50% process latency reduction during an 18,000-user EHR migration at Callen-Lorde) by converting operational pain points into clear, actionable technical feedback and workflow documentation.
- **Data Governance & Integrity:** Grounded in formal quantitative modeling and data architecture principles, ensuring that data collection, reporting, and analytics pipelines adhere to strict quality standards, privacy regulations, and agency priorities.
- **Inclusive Leadership & Collaboration:** As an elected union delegate representing 300+ personnel, I lead with empathy, cultural humility, and transparent communication. I excel at building cross-functional alignment between IT partners, program managers, and diverse staff to cultivate an inclusive, customer-centered work environment.

Public human services rely on trusted data to deliver equitable outcomes. I bring the technical literacy required to oversee data operations alongside the operational discipline and human empathy needed to ensure those systems serve people effectively.

My transition to Oregon is a deliberate personal priority, and I am prepared to align my relocation timeline immediately upon selection. Thank you for your time, consideration, and service to the state of Oregon. I look forward to discussing how my operational and quantitative background can support the ODHS Data Office.

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